# Architecture & Interiors

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## Historic styles

**Ancient Egyptian temple** ancient Egyptian temple, twin sloping sandstone pylon towers flanking a tall gateway, carved hieroglyph reliefs, obelisk and sphinx avenue in front, harsh golden desert sunlight, deep blue shadows

**Mesopotamian ziggurat** Mesopotamian ziggurat, three stacked mud-brick terraces with grooved buttressed walls, long converging stairways rising to a small shrine on top, warm dusk light, date palms on a flat plain

**Persian Achaemenid** Achaemenid Persian palace ruins, very tall slender fluted stone columns crowned with double bull capitals, raised terrace with relief bands of marching figures, pale limestone, mountain backdrop, clear dry light

**Mesoamerican stepped pyramid** Maya stepped pyramid, steep tiers of pale limestone, single steep central staircase up to a small temple with a pierced roof comb, rising above dense green rainforest, soft humid light

**Byzantine domed church** Byzantine domed church, broad shallow lead-grey dome on a drum ringed with small arched windows, cascading half-domes, walls banded in red brick and cream stone, warm late afternoon light

**Romanesque** Romanesque stone church, thick rough-cut walls, round-arched portal set deep in stepped arches, small narrow windows, square bell tower with paired arched openings, overcast soft light, green meadow

**Islamic / Moorish** Moorish palace courtyard, arcade of horseshoe arches on slender marble columns, lace-carved stucco walls, geometric tile dado, long still reflecting pool lined with clipped myrtle, bright sun and cool shade

**Dravidian Hindu temple** South Indian Dravidian temple gateway, a tall tapering gopuram of many tiers crowded with brightly painted sculpted figures, barrel-vaulted crown with gold finials, red and white striped walls, palms, warm sun

**Khmer temple** Khmer temple at dawn, five lotus-bud sandstone towers rising over long carved galleries, mirrored in a still moat, weathered grey-brown stone, palm silhouettes, pink and apricot sky

**Chinese imperial hall** Chinese imperial palace hall, sweeping double-eaved hipped roof of yellow glazed tiles with upturned corners, rows of red lacquered columns, blue and green painted brackets, white marble terrace, clear blue sky

**Sahelian mud architecture** Sahelian mud-brick mosque facade, smooth hand-plastered ochre walls, tapering towers and cone pinnacles, rows of wooden beams bristling from the walls, egg finials, harsh noon sun, sandy square

**Italian Renaissance palazzo** Italian Renaissance palazzo facade, rusticated stone ground floor, rows of round-arched windows with alternating pediments, massive overhanging cornice, warm honey sandstone, symmetrical, soft Florentine light

**Baroque** Baroque church facade, curving two-storey front with paired columns, giant scroll volutes, broken pediment and oval window, rooftop statues, dome behind, warm stone raking in dramatic sunlight

**Palladian villa** Palladian villa, perfectly symmetrical pale stucco house with a six-column temple portico and pediment, low central dome, matching wings, broad stone steps, lawns and cypresses, calm summer light

**Russian Orthodox onion domes** Russian Orthodox church with a cluster of onion domes, some gilded and some painted in spiral stripes of red, green and blue, white walls with rounded kokoshnik gables, gold crosses, crisp winter sky

**Georgian townhouse** Georgian brick townhouse terrace, flat red brick facade, rows of white six-over-six sash windows, black panelled front door under a semicircular fanlight, iron railings, grey overcast London light

**Spanish colonial mission** Spanish colonial mission church, thick whitewashed adobe walls, curved bell gable with bronze bells in arched openings, red clay tile roof, shaded arcade, heavy wooden door, palms, bright desert sun

**Greek Revival** Greek Revival house, white painted temple front with six tall columns under a wide triangular pediment, green shutters, door with sidelights, broad lawn and old shade trees, bright summer afternoon

**Gothic Revival / Victorian Gothic** Victorian Gothic building, red brick banded with cream and black, steep slate gables, pointed lancet windows with striped arches and tracery, tall spired clock tower, moody overcast sky

**Second Empire** Second Empire mansion, steep mansard roof in patterned grey slate with arched dormers and iron cresting, taller central pavilion, tall windows under curved hoods, pale walls, late afternoon light

**Beaux-Arts** Beaux-Arts public building, symmetrical pale limestone facade, huge central arched entrance flanked by paired columns, sculpture group on the roofline, rusticated base, wide ceremonial steps, ornate lamps

**Queen Anne Victorian** Queen Anne Victorian house, asymmetrical with a round corner turret and conical roof, wraparound porch with spindles, patterned fish-scale shingles, sage green with cream and maroon trim, picket fence

## Modern movements

**Chicago School skyscraper** Chicago School skyscraper, 1890s steel-frame office tower clad in warm terracotta, heavy stone base with arched entries, rows of wide three-part windows, ornate cornice, sooty city street, overcast daylight

**Art Nouveau architecture** Art Nouveau metro entrance, sea-green cast-iron stems curling into whiplash arches and plant-like lamps with glowing amber glass, enamel sign panel, cream limestone facade behind, Paris street in soft daylight

**Catalan Modernisme** Catalan Modernisme facade, wavy sandstone roofline shimmering with broken-tile mosaic in turquoise, cobalt and gold, bone-like columns, mask-shaped iron balconies, slender organic tower with ceramic finial, bright Mediterranean light

**Prairie School** Prairie School house, long low brick home with wide flat hipped roofs and deep shadowed eaves, ribbons of geometric art-glass windows, broad central chimney, stone planter urns, midwestern lawn, late afternoon sun

**Craftsman bungalow** Craftsman bungalow, low gabled house with sage-green shingle siding, deep front porch on tapered columns over river-stone piers, exposed rafter tails and knee braces, cream trim, oak door, leafy street

**Amsterdam School** Amsterdam School building, sculpted red-brown brick block with a rounded corner tower and pointed crown, horizontal brick bands, clusters of small white-framed windows, steep tile roof, reflected in a calm canal

**Expressionist architecture** Expressionist architecture, smooth cream-rendered observatory tower that looks sculpted from clay, rounded flowing base, deep curved window slots, small dome on top, set among dark trees, soft daylight

**Pueblo Revival** Pueblo Revival building, terraced adobe-tan stucco blocks with soft rounded edges, rows of projecting log beam ends, small deep windows with turquoise frames, wooden ladder, strong desert sun, deep blue sky

**Spanish Colonial Revival** Spanish Colonial Revival villa, white stucco walls and red clay tile roofs, round-arched arcade, small bell tower, black wrought-iron balcony, pink bougainvillea, tall palms, warm California sun

**Streamline Moderne** Streamline Moderne building, smooth white stucco with a sweeping rounded corner, ribbon windows and triple horizontal speed-line bands in teal, porthole window, glass-block entrance, vertical fin, pastel sunset sky

**Googie** Googie diner, upswept boomerang roof in white and turquoise, wall of glass glowing warm inside, tall neon pylon sign with a starburst and atomic orbits, vintage car fins, purple and orange dusk sky

**Desert modernism** Desert modernist house, razor-thin white flat roof over floor-to-ceiling glass, patterned breeze-block wall, stone accent wall, turquoise pool, palms and agave on pale gravel, bare brown mountains, clear desert light

**Tropical modernism** Tropical modernist house, white concrete frame with deep overhanging roof, vertical sun fins and dark timber louvres, open shaded ground floor, plants tumbling from ledges, lotus pond, dense jungle, humid diffused light

**Metabolism** Metabolist capsule tower, two raw concrete cores studded with stacked white box capsules, each with one round porthole window, irregular plug-in arrangement, gray Tokyo sky, 1970s futurism

**High-tech architecture** High-tech building, glass box wrapped in an exposed white steel frame with X cross-bracing, bright blue, red, green and yellow service pipes running up the facade, glass escalator tube climbing diagonally, crisp daylight

**Critical regionalism** Contemporary house rooted in its landscape, dry-stone base wall stepping down the hillside, white rendered volume with timber slat screen, mono-pitch metal roof following the slope, olive trees, soft afternoon light

**Minimalist concrete** Minimalist concrete interior, smooth gray walls with a neat grid of tie holes, a single tall slit of daylight cutting through the wall, beam of light across a still reflecting pool, lone figure, silent and spare

**Blobitecture** Blobitecture department store, huge bulging amorphous building with no corners, deep blue skin covered in thousands of polished aluminium discs, glossy highlights, curved glass entrance, ordinary boxy city blocks around it

**Neo-futurism** Neo-futurist building, enormous sweeping white ribbed shell curving up like a bird's wing, glass beneath the arc, slender white ribs repeating, mirrored in a turquoise reflecting pool, cloudless blue sky

**Biophilic / vertical forest** Vertical forest residential tower, white concrete balconies staggered on every floor, each overflowing with real trees and shrubs, layers of green climbing the facade, glass behind, bright city sky, lush and alive

**Modern Nordic** Modern Nordic house, simple steep-gabled black timber barn with no eaves, huge gable window glowing with pale wood interior, light timber deck, white birch trees, wild grass meadow, soft overcast light

**Mass-timber architecture** Mass-timber office building, glass facade revealing exposed honey-colored glulam columns and cross-laminated timber floors on every level, larch fin cladding, warm interior glow, stack of CLT panels on the plaza

## Homes & streets

**Adobe pueblo** terraced adobe pueblo with stacked flat-roofed rooms, smooth rounded tan mud-plaster walls, protruding wooden roof beams, wooden ladders, small blue-trimmed windows, high desert sun and sharp shadows

**Log cabin** rustic log cabin of stacked honey-brown round logs with notched corner ends, fieldstone chimney with drifting smoke, small glowing windows, dark pine forest and dusky mountain sky

**A-frame cabin** mid-century A-frame cabin, steep dark roof sloping to the snowy ground, full triangular glass gable glowing amber at twilight, timber deck, tall snowy pines and blue mountain dusk

**Thatched cottage** storybook thatched cottage with a thick rounded golden straw roof and eyebrow dormer, whitewashed walls, low green door, small paned windows, pink climbing roses and a white picket fence, soft morning light

**Tudor half-timbered house** Tudor half-timbered house, dark oak beams in crosses and diagonals over cream plaster, jettied upper floor, steep gable, diamond-paned leaded windows, tall red brick chimney, soft English daylight

**Cape Cod cottage** classic Cape Cod cottage with weathered silver-gray cedar shingles, crisp white trim, steep dark roof with two dormers, central red door, navy shutters, blue hydrangeas and dune grass, clear coastal light

**Scandinavian red cottage** Swedish falu red wooden cottage with white window frames and corner boards, dark tiled roof, birch trees and a wildflower meadow sloping to a blue lake, soft long summer evening light

**Cycladic whitewashed house** Cycladic island village of whitewashed cube houses with rounded edges, cobalt blue doors and a blue dome, white steps, magenta bougainvillea, deep blue sea below, dazzling midday sun

**Japanese machiya townhouse** traditional Kyoto machiya townhouse, dark wood facade with fine vertical lattice screens, gray tiled eave, cream plaster upper floor with slatted windows, indigo noren curtain, paper lantern, quiet stone lane

**Moroccan riad** inside a Moroccan riad courtyard, rose plaster walls with horseshoe arches, zellige mosaic tile in green and blue, central tiled fountain, potted orange trees, carved cedar gallery above, dappled sun from the open sky

**Yurt (ger)** Mongolian ger with white felt walls and shallow cone roof, red rope bands, ornate orange painted door, thin stovepipe smoke, lone rider nearby, endless golden steppe and snow-tipped mountains under a vast blue sky

**Stilt house** tropical stilt house of woven bamboo raised on timber posts over calm green water, steep palm-thatch roof, wooden ladder and dugout canoe, coconut palm, warm hazy sunset reflected in the water

**Creole shotgun house** New Orleans shotgun house painted teal with white gingerbread trim, front-facing gable, full-height louvered shutters, raised porch on brick piers, pastel neighbors close on each side, humid golden light

**Hacienda** sprawling Spanish colonial hacienda, whitewashed stucco walls under red barrel-tile roofs, long shaded arcade of round arches, carved wooden doors, magenta bougainvillea, agave and terracotta pots, warm dry afternoon

**Boathouse on a lake** red wooden boathouse standing in a glassy lake, wide arched boat door at the waterline with a varnished boat inside, white trim, small dock, dark pine shoreline, perfect mirror reflection in calm morning light

**Haussmann boulevard** Parisian Haussmann boulevard, uniform cream limestone apartment facades with long wrought-iron balconies, tall French windows, gray zinc mansard roofs, chestnut trees, café awnings, soft overcast light

**Brownstone row houses** row of New York brownstone townhouses, chocolate sandstone facades, tall stoops with black iron railings, bay windows, ornate cornices, leafy trees dappling the sidewalk, late afternoon sun

**Painted Ladies** row of Victorian Painted Ladies, wooden houses in mint, pink, lavender and butter yellow with contrasting trim, steep gables and bay windows, green park slope in front, hazy city skyline behind, crisp sunny day

**Amsterdam canal houses** Amsterdam canal houses, tall narrow dark brick facades with stepped and bell gables, white window frames, hoisting beams, bicycles along the railing, reflections in the still green canal, soft gray light

**Mediterranean hill town** Mediterranean hill town of ochre and cream stone houses stacked up a hill under overlapping terracotta roofs, bell tower at the top, dark cypress trees on the slopes, warm golden evening light

**Medina alleyways** narrow medina alleyway between tall sun-baked ochre walls, pointed arch ahead, carved blue door, hanging rugs and a brass lantern, a dusty shaft of sunlight cutting through deep shade

**Beijing hutong** quiet Beijing hutong lane, gray brick walls and curved gray tile roofs, red lacquered courtyard gate with brass studs and painted beams, red lanterns, a parked bicycle, scholar tree shade

**Hong Kong tower blocks** dense wall of Hong Kong residential towers, faded pastel facades with endless tiny windows, air conditioners and colorful laundry, steep green mountain behind, humid hazy daylight

**Soviet panel blocks** Soviet-era prefab panel apartment block, gray-beige concrete panels with visible seams, identical windows and mismatched glazed balconies, birch trees and a rusty playground, flat overcast light

**Favela hillside** dense favela hillside of stacked bare orange brick and brightly painted concrete houses, blue rooftop water tanks, tangled wires, steep jungle-green mountain above, bright tropical sunlight

**Small-town Main Street** small-town American Main Street, two-storey red and tan brick storefronts with ornate cornices, striped awnings and painted signs, lampposts and a flag, a vintage car at the curb, warm afternoon sun

**Tokyo backstreet** narrow Tokyo backstreet at dusk, glowing red paper lanterns and noren curtains, vertical shop signs, tangle of overhead power lines on concrete poles, lit vending machine, wet asphalt reflecting warm light

**Venetian canal** Venetian canal lined with faded pink and ochre palazzi, white Gothic arched windows, striped mooring poles, a black gondola gliding on jade-green water, rippling reflections, soft hazy light

**Suburban cul-de-sac** aerial view of a suburban cul-de-sac, round gray asphalt turnaround ringed by similar houses with hipped roofs, driveways and bright green lawns, young trees casting short shadows, midday sun

## Materials & finishes

**Board-formed concrete** board-formed concrete wall, cool grey surface printed with horizontal timber plank grain and seams, neat rows of round tie holes, low raking sunlight revealing the texture

**Exposed brick** exposed red brick wall in Flemish bond, alternating long stretchers and darker short headers, varied clay tones, pale lime mortar, warm low sunlight raking across the surface

**Rammed earth** rammed earth wall with horizontal striped layers of ochre, tan and rust soil, gritty pebbly texture, thick monolithic mass, warm desert light grazing the surface

**Ashlar stone** ashlar masonry wall of large squared honey-colored limestone blocks in level courses, hairline joints, subtle tone variation between stones, soft afternoon light

**Fieldstone / rubble wall** fieldstone wall of irregular rounded stones in mixed grey, brown and ochre, deep shadowed mortar joints, rustic handmade texture, low sun raking across the stones

**Heavy timber frame** interior of a heavy timber frame building, thick dark oak posts and beams joined with wooden pegs, diagonal knee braces, white plaster walls, warm window light on wide plank floor

**Shou sugi ban (charred timber)** shou sugi ban cladding, vertical charred black timber boards with a cracked alligator-skin texture, silvery sheen where low light catches the scales, crisp board gaps

**Corten (weathering) steel** tall Corten weathering steel wall, mottled rust orange and deep brown plates with darker drip streaks, thin crisp seams, rust stains on the pale gravel below, soft daylight

**Glass curtain wall** glass curtain wall office tower façade, grid of slim dark aluminum mullions, panes mirroring blue sky, clouds and a warped neighboring tower, crisp diagonal glare

**Glass block** glass block wall, grid of thick square translucent blocks with rippled inner pattern, pale aqua tint, thin grey mortar joints, warm light glowing through, blurred plant beyond

**Terracotta cladding** façade of horizontal terracotta baguettes, rows of slim rounded orange-red fired clay rods with soft shadow gaps, slender vertical fins, warm glazing glowing behind

**Stucco / lime render** sunlit lime-rendered stucco wall in warm off-white, gently uneven troweled texture, deep-set arched window, crisp shadows, terracotta pot with a plant, Mediterranean light

**Copper with verdigris** copper dome weathered to chalky blue-green verdigris, standing seams converging to a finial, streaks of brown copper showing through, pale sky behind

**Cedar shingles** weathered cedar shingle wall, overlapping staggered rows in mixed silver grey and honey tones, shadow line under each course, crisp white-trimmed window, coastal light

**Terrazzo** polished terrazzo floor, pale cream base scattered with angular chips of charcoal, terracotta, ochre and sage, thin brass divider strip, soft reflected window light

**Marble with veining** book-matched Calacatta marble wall, bright white polished stone with bold flowing grey and gold veins mirrored at the center seam, soft glossy reflections

**Travertine** honed travertine wall, warm beige stone with fine horizontal banding and small elongated pits, large tiles with thin joints, soft raking sunlight

**Zellige tile** handmade zellige tile wall, small glossy squares in deep emerald with uneven surfaces and edges, rich tone variation, light glinting off pooled glaze, thin cream grout

**Encaustic cement tile** encaustic cement tile floor, bold repeating star and circle motif in navy, terracotta, ochre and cream, matte chalky surface with gentle wear, patterns joining across tiles

**Subway tile** white glossy subway tile wall in a staggered brick pattern, slightly beveled edges, thin grey grout, soft highlights, wooden shelf and countertop, calm daylight

**Limewash paint** limewash wall in soft clay pink, cloudy mottled color with visible crisscross brush strokes, chalky matte surface, low plinth with a dark ceramic vase and a branch shadow

**Tadelakt / Venetian plaster** tadelakt bathroom, seamless polished lime plaster in warm terracotta with a soft satin sheen and cloudy burnish marks, rounded arched niche, curved edges, no grout lines

**Microcement** minimal room in seamless microcement, warm grey floor, walls and built-in bench flowing as one surface, soft cloudy trowel marks, satin finish, diffuse window light

**Herringbone parquet** herringbone oak parquet floor, short honey-toned planks in a zigzag, varied grain from plank to plank, satin oiled finish, a stripe of sunlight across the boards

**Wainscoting & paneling** room with sage-green painted wainscoting, framed raised panels with beveled moldings, chair rail and tall baseboard, warm cream plaster above, brass sconce glowing

**Rattan & cane** rattan chair back with woven cane webbing, honey-colored mesh with octagonal holes, rounded bentwood frame, wrapped legs, soft patterned shadow on a cream wall

**Bouclé upholstery** curvy armchair upholstered in cream bouclé, nubby looped wool texture, rounded sculptural silhouette, soft matte shading, warm taupe wall behind

**Velvet** channel-tufted emerald velvet sofa, plush pile shimmering bright on each rounded channel and near-black in the folds, soft crush marks, dusty pink wall

**Brass & bronze fittings** unlacquered brass gooseneck faucet and cross handles on a white marble counter, brass bar pulls on deep green cabinets, bright warm highlights

**High-gloss lacquer** high-gloss oxblood lacquered cabinetry, mirror-like surface reflecting a window and a warm lamp, sharp highlight edges, thin brass pulls, dark glossy floor

## Interior styles

**Rococo salon** Rococo salon interior, pale mint walls with carved white and gilt boiserie panels, ornate gold scroll mirror over a marble fireplace, pink silk bergère chairs on curved legs, crystal chandelier, parquet floor, soft daylight

**French Provincial** French Provincial farmhouse kitchen, limewashed plaster walls and dark beams, hexagonal terracotta tile floor, carved sage-painted armoire, rush-seat chair, blue gingham tablecloth, lavender by a shuttered window, warm sun

**Chinoiserie** Chinoiserie drawing room, hand-painted celadon wallpaper with flowering branches and birds, red lacquer cabinet with brass fittings, blue and white ginger jars, black fretwork chair, navy rug, soft lamplight

**Shaker** Shaker room, plain white plaster walls with a wooden peg rail, chair hung upside down on a peg, ladderback chair with blue woven seat, maple trestle table with stacked oval boxes, muted blue-green trim, quiet daylight

**Victorian parlor** Victorian parlor, deep burgundy damask wallpaper and dark wood paneling, plum velvet button-tufted sofa, heavy green drapes with gold tassels, fringed table lamp, gilt-framed portraits, potted fern, Persian rug, dim lamplight

**English country house** English country house sitting room, warm yellow walls and cream paneling, faded chintz sofa with mismatched cushions, skirted table with pleated lamp, oil landscapes, worn rug, dog bed, sash window onto a garden

**Art Deco interior** Art Deco living room, cream fluted walls, black lacquer stepped fireplace with a gold sunburst mirror, curved burgundy velvet club chairs, chrome and glass side table, black and white floor, warm uplighting

**Hollywood Regency** Hollywood Regency living room, glossy emerald lacquered walls, black and white checkerboard floor, hot pink tufted settee on gold legs, gilt sunburst mirror over a mirrored console, white ginger jar lamps, potted palm

**Mid-century modern interior** Mid-century modern living room, glass wall onto trees, walnut slat wall, low mustard sofa on tapered legs, molded lounge chair, teak credenza with ceramics, arc floor lamp, sunburst clock, warm afternoon light

**1970s conversation pit** 1970s sunken conversation pit, built-in burnt orange cushions around a sunken well, brown shag carpet, wood-paneled walls, round low coffee table, amber globe pendants, macramé plant hanger, golden sunset through a ribbon window

**Scandinavian** Scandinavian living room, white walls and pale oak floor, light grey sofa with sheepskin throw, round birch coffee table, white pendant lamp, wishbone chair, fiddle leaf fig, soft northern daylight

**Japandi** Japandi living room, warm beige walls, low oak platform sofa with oatmeal linen cushions, slatted wood screen, paper lantern floor lamp, low dark coffee table with handmade ceramics, single branch, jute rug, soft diffused light

**Wabi-sabi** wabi-sabi interior, hand-troweled clay plaster walls, rough timber bench, uneven handmade stoneware, dried branches in a rough vase, rumpled linen, worn concrete floor, deep plaster niche, soft low shadowy light

**Industrial loft** industrial loft, exposed red brick wall, tall black steel factory windows, polished concrete floor, exposed silver ductwork, bare Edison bulb pendants, cognac leather sofa, reclaimed wood and steel coffee table

**Bohemian** bohemian living room, layered kilim rugs, rattan peacock chair, floor cushions and pouf, macramé wall hanging, hanging trailing plants, warm string lights, terracotta and rust tones, arched window

**Coastal** coastal living room, white shiplap walls, washed oak floor, white slipcovered sofa with navy striped pillows, rattan armchair, jute rug, driftwood coffee table, sheer linen curtains, big window onto the sea

**Modern farmhouse** modern farmhouse dining room, white shiplap walls, reclaimed wood beams, sliding barn door on a black rail, black-framed windows, black metal dome pendant over a chunky wood table, cross-back chairs

**Minimalist** minimalist living room, bare white walls, pale concrete floor, one long low sofa, a single small artwork, one black stool with a vase, huge frameless window, soft even daylight, almost empty

**Dark academia** dark academia study, deep green walls, floor-to-ceiling bookshelves, worn leather wingback chair with tartan throw, dark wood desk with green banker's lamp, antique globe, candle, rainy arched window

**Cottagecore** cottagecore kitchen, small floral wallpaper, low wooden beams, gingham tablecloth with wildflowers in a jug, painted sage dresser with plates, patchwork cushion, wicker basket, sunny cottage window onto a flower garden

**Grandmillennial** grandmillennial living room, blue trellis wallpaper, chintz camelback sofa with ruffled pink skirt, pleated scalloped lampshade on a skirted table, blue and white plates on the wall, wicker chair with needlepoint pillow

**Quiet luxury** quiet luxury living room, greige oak paneled walls washed in soft light, curved cream bouclé sofa, travertine coffee table with a single dark vase, cashmere throw, large stone floor tiles, calm muted palette

**Moroccan-inspired** Moroccan-inspired lounge, terracotta plaster walls, teal zellige tile dado, keyhole arch onto a sunny courtyard, low banquettes with patterned cushions, pierced brass lanterns, brass tray table with tea glasses

**Eclectic maximalist** eclectic maximalist living room, deep teal walls with a dense gallery wall of mixed frames, raspberry velvet sofa piled with patterned pillows, black and cream striped armchair, leopard rug, colorful lamp, palms

## Spaces & elements

**Great hall** a medieval great hall, soaring dark oak hammerbeam roof, rough stone walls, tall lancet windows, roaring fireplace, long candlelit trestle table, heraldic banners, worn flagstone floor

**Library (double-height with ladders)** a double-height wooden library, books from floor to ceiling, an upper gallery with a carved railing, a rolling brass ladder, tall arched window, warm lamplight, a worn Persian rug

**Conservatory / orangery** a Victorian glass conservatory, white wrought-iron frame and curved glass roof, potted orange trees and tall palms, terracotta pots, humid green light, sun dappling a tiled floor

**Atrium** a bright multi-storey atrium, white balconies with glass railings stacked around an open void, a gridded glass roof above, a tall tree on the ground floor, soft daylight pouring down

**Reading nook (window seat)** a cozy window seat reading nook, deep cushioned bench in an alcove, built-in bookshelves on both sides, plump pillows, soft daylight through small-paned windows, a knitted blanket

**Enfilade (aligned doorways)** a palace enfilade, a long line of aligned doorways receding into the distance, gilded frames and open double doors, polished parquet, pastel walls, a bright window at the far end

**Attic room under the eaves** a cozy attic bedroom under the eaves, steep sloping white ceilings with dark exposed rafters, a small round window, a skylight beam, wide pine floorboards, a quilted bed

**Vaulted cellar** a barrel-vaulted brick cellar, curved arches repeating into darkness, oak wine barrels along the walls, one warm hanging lantern, cool damp air, worn stone floor

**Thermal baths / bathhouse** a grand thermal bathhouse, turquoise pool under tall stone arches, columns and mosaic bands, steam drifting in warm light, calm reflections, honey-colored stone

**Sunroom** a bright sunroom with white-framed windows on three sides, rattan armchairs, potted ferns, sunlight patches on a honey wood floor, a green garden all around

**Cloister** looking out from a shaded stone cloister, round arches framing a square garden, a small fountain where paths cross, terracotta roof beyond, quiet golden afternoon light

**Interior courtyard** a sunlit interior courtyard open to the sky, arched two-storey galleries, a tiled fountain at the center, orange trees, patterned floor tiles, cool shade and bright blue sky

**Rotunda** a grand marble rotunda, a ring of pale columns under a coffered dome, sunlight falling from a round opening onto a patterned circular floor, hushed and symmetrical

**Grand staircase hall** a grand imperial staircase hall, a wide marble stair splitting into two curving flights, a red carpet runner, carved balustrades, an arched upper gallery, a glowing crystal chandelier

**Double-height ceiling** a double-height living room, ceiling two storeys up, very tall windows, an upper landing looking down into the space, a long pendant light, warm afternoon light

**Clerestory windows** a calm room lit by a continuous band of clerestory windows just under the ceiling, sunbeams slanting down across a plain plaster wall, solid lower walls

**Oculus / skylight** a dark domed interior with a round oculus at the top, a single shaft of sunlight falling through the air, a bright disc of light on the stone floor

**Colonnade** a long classical colonnade of pale stone columns receding into the distance, strong diagonal shadows striping the walkway, bright sun, deep blue sky

**Arcade** a sunlit stone arcade, a row of round arches on slender piers, deep shade behind, warm ochre walls, arch-shaped pools of light on the pavement

**Cantilever** a modern house with a long cantilevered volume jutting out over a cliff edge, nothing supporting it below, warm glowing windows, a deep shadow underneath, wide sky

**Spiral staircase** a sculptural spiral staircase of warm oak treads curling around a slim brass pole, a continuous curved handrail, light from above, dark concrete walls

**Mezzanine** a loft apartment with a warm timber mezzanine over half the room, a slim railing, an open stair leading up, tall windows lighting the double-height space beside it

**Coffered / vaulted ceiling** looking up at a deep coffered ceiling, a grid of recessed square panels with gilded edges and warm shadows, receding toward the far wall, classical and rich

**Bay window** a Victorian house with a three-sided bay window projecting from a brick facade, white painted frames, warm lamplight glowing inside, a small slate roof above

**Moon gate** a circular moon gate in a whitewashed garden wall with dark tile coping, framing bamboo, a red maple and a winding stone path beyond, soft misty light

**Pilotis** a white modernist house raised on slender pilotis, thin round columns lifting the box above a green lawn, deep cool shadow beneath, long ribbon windows, clear sky

**Brise-soleil** a concrete facade covered in a deep brise-soleil grid, crisp horizontal and vertical fins casting sharp geometric shadows over recessed dark windows, hot bright sun

**Mashrabiya screen** a dark room with a carved wooden mashrabiya lattice screen over the window, warm sunlight glowing through the delicate pattern, dappled light spilling across the floor

**Floor-to-ceiling glazing** a minimalist living room with floor-to-ceiling glazing, slim black frames, a wide view of mountains and a lake, soft reflections on the glass, pale light on concrete

**Dormer windows** a pitched slate roof with three white gabled dormer windows glowing warmly, neat trim, a brick chimney, soft evening sky behind

## Landscape & public space

**French formal parterre** French formal parterre seen from a palace terrace, low clipped box hedges in swirling scroll patterns, raked pale gravel, cone topiaries, round stone fountain basin, perfect symmetry to the horizon

**English landscape garden** English landscape garden, rolling green lawn sloping to a curving serpentine lake, clumps of ancient oaks and beeches, small domed classical temple on the far bank, soft hazy afternoon light

**Japanese dry garden (karesansui)** Japanese dry rock garden, raked white gravel in fine parallel lines rippling around mossy weathered stones, low ochre clay wall with grey tile coping, pine branch above, still overcast light

**Japanese stroll and moss garden** Japanese stroll garden around a still pond, thick velvet moss, irregular stepping stones, granite lantern, red arched drum bridge, flaming red maple leaves, soft dappled light

**Chinese scholar's garden** Chinese scholar's garden, white plaster wall with a round moon gate framing bamboo, pierced grey limestone rock, pavilion with upswept dark tile roof and red columns over a lotus pond

**Mughal charbagh** Mughal charbagh garden, long narrow water channels crossing at a square pool, small fountain jets, raised red sandstone walks, lines of dark cypress, white marble domed pavilion beyond, warm haze

**Italian Renaissance terraced garden** Italian Renaissance terraced garden on a hillside, stone balustrades and wide stairs climbing to an ochre villa, rows of slim dark cypress, umbrella pines, stone fountain, golden Tuscan light

**English cottage garden** English cottage garden overflowing with foxgloves, hollyhocks and delphiniums, roses climbing a limewashed cottage with thatched roof, narrow brick path, white picket fence, soft summer light

**Mediterranean courtyard garden** sunlit Mediterranean courtyard, whitewashed walls, terracotta tile floor, small fountain clad in blue and yellow tiles, potted lemon tree and red geraniums, bougainvillea spilling over, blue arched door

**Desert xeriscape** desert xeriscape garden, tan gravel and flagstone path, blue-grey agaves, golden barrel cacti, spindly ocotillo, rust-colored boulders, crisp shadows under a clear sky, distant mesa

**New Perennial meadow planting** naturalistic meadow planting, drifts of feathery ornamental grasses, purple salvia spikes and pink coneflowers, dark seedheads, low golden evening backlight glowing through the grass

**Topiary & hedge maze** hedge maze seen from above at an angle, tall clipped dark green yew walls with crisp flat tops, narrow pale gravel corridors, spiral topiaries at the corners, long late-day shadows

**Picturesque ruin & folly** romantic garden folly, roofless gothic stone ruin with pointed window arches and ivy, fallen blocks in long grass, reflected in a still lake, brooding grey-gold sky

**Kitchen potager** ornamental kitchen potager, geometric beds edged in clipped box, rows of blue-green cabbages and red lettuces, bean teepees, worn brick paths, glass cloche, espaliered pears on a warm brick wall

**Piazza** sunlit Italian piazza, fan-patterned brick paving, ochre and terracotta facades with a shaded ground-floor arcade, stone fountain at the center, brick bell tower, strolling people

**Waterfront promenade / boardwalk** seaside boardwalk promenade, weathered timber planks receding along white railings, ornate double lamp posts, benches facing a bright blue sea, sailboat on the horizon, breezy midday light

**Covered market hall** bustling covered market hall, green cast-iron columns and trusses under a glass roof, fan-shaped gable window, rows of stalls with red and white striped awnings piled with fruit

**Glass-roofed shopping arcade (galleria)** grand nineteenth-century shopping galleria, arched glass and iron barrel-vault roof, ornate cream stone facades with glowing shopfronts, polished mosaic floor, soft daylight from above

**Railway station concourse** vast railway station concourse, arched iron ribs and glass roof, radiating glazed end wall, hanging station clock, train at the platform, shafts of light through haze, hurrying travelers

**Victorian palm house** Victorian palm house, curving white iron and glass dome with lower wings, tall palms glimpsed through misty glass, formal bedding and lawn in front, soft overcast daylight

**Lighthouse & keeper's cottage** white lighthouse with red bands and glass lantern on a rocky headland, small whitewashed keeper's cottage with slate roof, waves breaking on dark rocks, gulls, soft dusk light

**Lakeside dock & pier** timber lakeside pier running into still water, wooden rowboat tied alongside, red boathouse on the shore, dark pine forest and snow-dusted mountains, mirror reflections, calm morning light

**Stone arch bridge** old stone arch bridge over a calm river, three round arches with wedge-shaped voussoirs reflected into circles, low parapet with walkers, leafy riverbanks, warm afternoon light

**Suspension bridge** long suspension bridge at sunset, two tall rust-red towers, main cables sweeping in deep curves with fine vertical hangers, slim deck with tiny headlights, glowing water below

**Amphitheater** ancient open-air amphitheater, semicircular tiers of pale weathered stone seats with radial stair aisles, round orchestra and low stage, cypress trees and blue sea beyond, raking sunlight

**Rooftop garden terrace** city rooftop garden terrace at dusk, warm timber deck, dark planters of ornamental grasses, pergola with climbing vines, glowing string lights, lounge chairs, skyline with lit windows

**Lido / outdoor pool** Art Deco lido, long turquoise outdoor pool with rippling light and lane lines, crisp white streamlined pavilion with blue and coral stripes, diving board, striped umbrellas, bright summer sun

## Set design & imagined worlds

**Forced perspective** forced perspective film set, a short street of facades that shrink sharply toward a vanishing point, raked floor, tiny doors at the far end, an actor at the back looking giant

**Painted backdrop & flats** theatre stage of painted backdrop and layered cut-out flats, hand-painted sky and rolling hills on canvas, flat wooden tree and cottage cut-outs, visible braces, warm stage light

**Proscenium stage set** view from the audience of a proscenium stage, gilded arch and red velvet curtains framing a three-walled drawing room set, warm footlights, dark silhouettes of heads in the stalls

**Dollhouse cutaway set** dollhouse cutaway set, a whole house sliced open to the camera, rooms side by side and stacked, each with different pastel wallpaper and furniture, small figures going about their day, flat frontal view

**Miniature model set** handmade miniature model set on a workbench, tiny painted houses and lollipop trees on a grassy base, tweezers placing a tree, shallow depth of field, warm workshop lamp

**Period set dressing** Victorian parlour period set, dark green damask wallpaper, marble fireplace with gilded mirror, oil lamp glow, wingback armchair, oriental rug, candlesticks on the mantel, warm low light

**Lived-in production design** lived-in kitchen production design, cluttered open shelves of mismatched jars, notes on the fridge, dishes stacked in the sink, worn linoleum, jacket over a chair, warm pendant light

**Liminal space** liminal space, an empty office corridor receding into the distance, buzzing fluorescent ceiling panels, yellowed beige walls and mustard carpet, identical closed doors, no people, flat greenish light

**Abandoned interior** abandoned interior, faded green walls with peeling paint and exposed brick, broken arched window, a dusty shaft of light across warped floorboards, vines and ferns growing inside, an overturned chair

**Infinity cove / cyclorama studio** infinity cove studio, seamless white floor curving into the wall with no horizon, a single orange chair in the middle casting a soft shadow, even diffuse light

**German Expressionist film set** German Expressionist film set, crooked leaning buildings with jagged triangular windows, zigzag street, light and shadow painted directly on the scenery, stark black and cream, grainy silent film look

**Symmetrical tableau set** perfectly symmetrical tableau set, flat frontal view of a pastel pink hotel facade, mirrored windows, topiary trees and lamps, a single bellboy in red standing dead centre, soft even light

**Cyberpunk megacity** cyberpunk megacity at night, dense dark towers covered in magenta and cyan neon signs, heavy rain, glowing pink haze, wet street reflections, a flying car between buildings

**Solarpunk city** solarpunk city, white rounded towers overflowing with garden terraces, solar panel arrays and slim wind turbines, a canal lined with trees, a clean tram, bright sunny sky

**Space Age retrofuturism** Space Age retrofuturist town, a flying-saucer observation tower on slender legs, a boomerang-roof diner with glass walls, starburst sign, monorail, teal and orange sunset sky

**Steampunk** steampunk city, riveted copper halls with glowing portholes, a clock tower, giant brass gears and pipes, an airship overhead, smokestacks puffing into a sepia sky

**Dieselpunk** dieselpunk city at smoggy dusk, stepped Art Deco skyscrapers with brass spires, searchlight beams crossing the sky, a zeppelin, smokestacks and an elevated train

**Fairy-tale castle** fairy-tale castle on a green hill, white walls and clustered round towers with tall pointed blue roofs, red pennants, arched gate, winding path, soft white clouds

**Elven / organic fantasy** elven fantasy architecture, a pale stone pavilion of slender curving columns and leaf-shaped arches under a seed-pod dome, bridges to giant trees, waterfall mist, golden-green forest light

**Storybook cottage** storybook cottage, thick swooping thatched roof with rolled eaves, crooked stone chimney puffing smoke, round green door, diamond-pane windows with flower boxes, wildflowers and a picket fence

**Gothic horror mansion** Gothic horror mansion at night, steep mansard roof and pointed tower silhouetted against a huge full moon, one window glowing yellow, bare twisted tree, iron fence, low fog

**Post-apocalyptic ruin** post-apocalyptic ruined city, jagged broken skyscrapers with empty windows, collapsed bridge, rubble and a rusted car, weeds reclaiming the street, thick orange dust haze, pale sun

**Arcology / megastructure** arcology megastructure, an enormous stepped pyramid city rising from the desert, endless rows of windows and planted terraces, atmospheric haze at its base, tiny houses for scale

**Floating sky city** floating sky city on a rocky island above a sea of clouds, white towers with golden domes and spires, hanging roots and a waterfall spilling off the edge, small airships

**Underwater habitat** underwater habitat, ribbed glass domes on the sea floor linked by tubes, warm glowing windows inside, deep blue water with light rays from above, kelp and fish, rising bubbles

**Sci-fi desert settlement** sci-fi desert settlement, smooth domed adobe dwellings around a sunken courtyard, slim metal moisture towers, rolling sand dunes, twin suns in a pale hot sky, a small hover vehicle

## Architects' signatures

**Giovanni Battista Piranesi** in the manner of Giovanni Battista Piranesi: an imaginary vaulted underground hall, colossal stone arches, crisscrossing stairways and wooden bridges, hanging chains, deep crosshatched shadows, beams of light, tiny figures, sepia etching

**Étienne-Louis Boullée** in the manner of Étienne-Louis Boullée: a new visionary monument, a colossal smooth stone sphere on a stepped circular plinth, ringed by dark cypresses, tiny human figures, solemn raking light, pale misty sky

**Antoni Gaudí** in the manner of Antoni Gaudí: a new apartment building with a rippling sandstone facade studded with blue and green broken-tile mosaic, bone-like columns, mask-shaped balconies, a scaly glazed roof and twisted mosaic chimneys

**Charles Rennie Mackintosh** in the manner of Charles Rennie Mackintosh: a new white roughcast house with a steep slate roof, a round stair tower, tall narrow small-paned windows, black lattice gates and stylized pink and purple rose motifs

**Edwin Lutyens** in the manner of Edwin Lutyens: a new English country house with a vast sweeping clay-tile roof, tall brick chimneys, warm red brick with pale stone dressings, small-paned windows, terraces, yew hedges and a stone rill

**Frank Lloyd Wright** in the manner of Frank Lloyd Wright: a new long low house hugging a lawn, deep cantilevered eaves, bands of geometric art-glass windows, thin tan Roman brick, a central chimney mass, stone planters, warm earthy palette

**Eileen Gray** in the manner of Eileen Gray: a new small white seaside villa raised on slim pilotis above rocks, strip windows, a terrace with tubular railings, a striped canvas sail awning, deep blue Mediterranean sea

**Le Corbusier** in the manner of Le Corbusier: a new raw board-marked concrete housing slab on chunky tapered pilotis, a deep egg-crate grid of sunshades, some balconies painted red, yellow and blue, sculptural rooftop forms

**Ludwig Mies van der Rohe** in the manner of Ludwig Mies van der Rohe: a new glass pavilion on a travertine plinth, a thin floating white roof slab, slender chrome columns, a freestanding green marble wall, a still black reflecting pool

**Hugh Ferriss** in the manner of Hugh Ferriss: a new colossal stepped setback skyscraper at night, rendered in soft charcoal, searchlight beams rising from the fog, deep black shadows, glowing mist at street level, monochrome

**Alvar Aalto** in the manner of Alvar Aalto: a new bright Nordic reading room with an undulating pine slat ceiling, round skylights, white walls, bent birch plywood chairs, a big window onto birches and a lake

**Luis Barragán** in the manner of Luis Barragán: a new quiet courtyard of tall plain stucco walls in hot pink, saffron yellow and violet, a long still water trough fed by a single spout, crisp shadows, deep blue sky

**Oscar Niemeyer** in the manner of Oscar Niemeyer: a new white concrete pavilion shaped like a shallow bowl on a slender stem, a sweeping curved ramp, rows of parabolic arches, reflecting pool, bright tropical blue sky

**Eero Saarinen** in the manner of Eero Saarinen: a new jet-age terminal with a vast swooping white concrete shell roof like spread wings, Y-shaped piers, a sweeping glass wall, warm sunset light

**Louis Kahn** in the manner of Louis Kahn: a new monumental red brick building with giant circular and triangular openings, concrete bands, deep shadowed voids, a travertine plaza with a narrow water channel

**Carlo Scarpa** in the manner of Carlo Scarpa: a new garden wall of grey concrete with stepped ziggurat edges, a pair of interlocking circular openings rimmed in gold mosaic and teal, a shallow water pool, brass details, dark cypresses

**John Lautner** in the manner of John Lautner: a new hillside house with a vast curved concrete roof cantilevering on one pedestal, a wraparound glass wall glowing warm, city lights spread below at dusk

**Geoffrey Bawa** in the manner of Geoffrey Bawa: a new low tropical house with a big clay-tile roof on slender white columns, a deep open veranda, a pool merging into a lake, frangipani and palms, soft humid light

**Lina Bo Bardi** in the manner of Lina Bo Bardi: a new community center of raw board-marked concrete towers with irregular cloud-shaped windows in red lattice, concrete bridges between towers, plants on top, an old brick hall

**Ricardo Bofill** in the manner of Ricardo Bofill: a new hillside housing citadel of interlocking stucco towers in red and pink, courtyards painted blue and violet, zigzag stairways, cross-shaped parapets, bright Mediterranean sun

**Friedensreich Hundertwasser** in the manner of Friedensreich Hundertwasser: a new apartment block with a patchwork facade of bright colors, wavy floor lines, mismatched windows, trees growing from windows, a grassy roof and a golden onion dome

**Zaha Hadid** in the manner of Zaha Hadid: a new cultural center of flowing white surfaces sweeping into a sharp cantilevered tip, dark glass bands following the curves, a plaza of converging lines, no right angles